

NovaCore Technologies: Employee Handbook & Policies

1. Hybrid & Remote Work Policy

NovaCore supports a flexible hybrid workplace. Employees residing within a 30-mile radius of a hub office are expected to work from the office on Tuesdays and Thursdays. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM in the employee's designated local timezone. Fully remote staff must maintain secure broadband connectivity and have a designated private workspace.

2. Paid Time Off (PTO) & Leave Allocations

Leave Category	Allowance per Year	Accrual / Rollover Terms
Paid Vacation	25 days	Accrues monthly; up to 5 days can roll over to Q1 of the following year.
Sick & Mental Health Leave	12 days	Available on Day 1; no medical certificate needed for <= 2 days.
Paid Parental Leave	16 weeks fully paid	Eligible after 6 months of tenure; applicable for birth or adoption.
Bereavement Leave	5 days	Immediate family members; additional unpaid time available on request.

3. Information Security & Device Usage

- All work must be conducted exclusively on company-provisioned Apple MacBooks or Lenovo ThinkPads with full-disk encryption enabled.
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) via hardware security key or Okta Verify is mandatory for all internal and cloud assets.
- Storing confidential customer data or source code on personal devices, external USB storage, or unapproved public cloud drives is strictly prohibited.

4. Expense Reimbursement & Stipends

- **Remote Setup Stipend:** A one-time allowance of \$1,000 upon hire to equip home ergonomic workstations.
- **Internet & Phone Reimbursement:** Up to \$100 per month for monthly broadband and cellular expenses.
- **Learning & Development:** \$2,000 annual budget per employee for conferences, courses, and technical books.
- **Travel Meals:** Daily per diem cap of \$85 for domestic business travel, receipts required for expenses exceeding \$25.

5. Whistleblower & Anti-Harassment Safeguards

NovaCore maintains zero tolerance for harassment, discrimination, or retaliation. Reports can be submitted confidentially to HR or via our anonymous 24/7 hotline at ethics@novacore.ai. All inquiries are investigated within 5 business days.